

Becoming a Sweet Water Well

Paul's Source Was the Spirit Who Searches the Deep Things of God

Go to James 3, and keep a marker nearby in 1 Corinthians 6.

We began this from 1 Corinthians 2, finding out Paul's source. Paul rebuked the Corinthians for carnality because one said, "I am of Paul," and another said, "I am of Apollos." Paul said one planted and another watered, but God gives the increase. Therefore, take heed how you build on the foundation. Do not build with hay, wood, or stubble.

Before Paul went into that correction, he revealed his source:

| The Spirit searcheth all things, yea, the deep things of God.

What was not available to the Old Testament saints is now available to us. The mystery hidden in God has been made known through the Great Commission: go into all the world and preach the gospel to every creature.

What did Paul do differently from other Holy Ghost prophets and apostles of his day? Why did he receive such revelation knowledge that the church's foundation came through his ministry? He said:

| I thank my God, I speak with tongues more than ye all.

Tongues means languages. He was speaking of a supernatural language of edification that encompasses the revelation of Jesus Christ.

Praying in Tongues Helps the Word Discern and Rebuild the Heart

Hebrews 4 says we must labor to enter into rest because the Word of God is alive, powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword. It divides soul and spirit and discerns the thoughts and intents of the heart.

The Word is the only qualified agent to deliver a distinct blow between spirit and soul so you can know which one you are operating from.

The devil works in the emotional realm of the soul. Preachers may say healing is not for today. Doctors may say you will die. Emotions may clamor. What standard discerns the intents and thoughts of the heart? Only the Word of God.

Praying in tongues assists this work. As you pray in the Holy Ghost, the Spirit moves on your mind with the mystery of Christ in you, the hope of glory. He discerns what is God and what is not, even in the emotional realms beyond the reach of the carnal mind. He pulls down what is not of God

and builds what is.

The Tongue Reports What Is in the Reservoir

James 3 deals with the tongue because the tongue reports what is happening inside a person. Jesus said every tree is known by its own fruit.

The tongue is like the drinking fountain that delivers from the reservoir. The heart is the reservoir. If there is arsenic in the reservoir, arsenic will come out through the fountain.

When you meditate the Word, confess it, and stand on it, you feed your spirit and strengthen your soul. When you pray in the Holy Ghost, you attack the problem from another direction: the Holy Spirit teaches your spirit and pulls down strongholds. The combination produces a transformed believer who can stand on the Word.

Teachers Receive Greater Judgment Because They Serve Others From the Reservoir

James says:

My brethren, be not many masters, knowing that we shall receive the greater condemnation.

"Masters" means teachers. A teacher uses the tongue to teach others. If the reservoir is poisoned, then what he teaches will put others in bondage.

James continues:

If any man offend not in word, the same is a perfect man, and able also to bridle the whole body.

He compares the tongue to a bit in a horse's mouth and a small helm on a great ship. Then he says the tongue is a fire, a world of iniquity, setting on fire the course of nature and being set on fire of hell.

Every kind of beast has been tamed by mankind, but the tongue no man can tame by natural means. It is unruly and full of deadly poison.

A Believer Cannot Truly Yield Both Sweet and Bitter Water

James says:

Therewith bless we God, even the Father; and therewith curse we men, which are made after the similitude of God.

Out of the same mouth proceedeth blessing and cursing. My brethren, these things ought not so to be.

Then he says:

Doth a fountain send forth at the same place sweet water and bitter?

So can no fountain both yield salt water and fresh.

At first this confused me. One verse says believers bless God and curse men. Another says no fountain can yield both salt and fresh water.

If the Word says bitter and sweet water cannot flow from the same fountain, then they cannot. When a believer blesses God and curses men, we may think both waters are flowing. But the truth is that the fountain is either sweet or salty.

The problem is that when a salt water well comes into our presence, the deception can appear sweet. It looks spiritual, trustworthy, and safe. But deception is itself bitter water. When the true character finally emerges and curses you, it was not a different water. The well was salty all along.

Spiritual Naivety Misjudges Salt Water Wells

Over the years, I have met many people in and around ministry. Like everyone else, I misjudged many of them. Some I thought were very spiritual shocked me by the lengths they would go to hurt and use people in their way. Others, whom I would not have thought much about, turned out to be enduring and trustworthy.

That is confusing to a young ministry that has not yet come to grips with human nature, especially born-again human nature that is not acting born again.

Most of us are gullible and naive. We fail to recognize a high-yield salt water well when we see one. We develop relationships with salt water fountains, not realizing that what we first trusted was bitter water in the form of deception.

We can understand babies coming out of drugs, abuse, or the world. They may still lie, scheme, or have eruptions while they are growing. Jesus expects us to make room for growth.

But long-time believers, preachers, elders, and knowledgeable sheep may know the language, finish every verse you start, and project exactly what you want to see, while having stopped the growth process in their own lives.

The Holy Ghost Bypasses the Soul and Works Where Permanent Change Begins

Paul says the Spirit searches the deep things of God to reveal them to us. The baptism of the Holy Ghost bypasses the soul realm and comes to the spirit, where permanent change begins.

The supernatural language of edification bypasses the intellect and emotionalism. It comes to rest in the spirit, where the Holy Spirit creates a language that encompasses the understanding of Christ in you, the hope of glory.

As we pray those mysteries before the Father, the answer comes back in the form of Him moving on our understanding of everything Christ is in us. That begins the purging process.

Jude says those who separate themselves are sensual, having not the Spirit. But:

Ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost...

We build ourselves above a sense-ruled walk, above carnality, and above the deception that separates people from truth.

First Corinthians Addresses Carnal Believers Who Needed Milk

Paul told the Corinthians there were many things he wanted to say, but they were not able to hear them because they were carnal. The whole book of 1 Corinthians is written to baby Christians still on milk.

That should sober us, because many preachers do not understand it.

In chapter 5, Paul instructs them to turn a man over to Satan for the destruction of the flesh so his spirit might be saved. In chapter 6, he rebukes believers for suing one another. In chapter 13, he reveals agape love that seeks not its own and takes no account of evil done to it.

What kind of book is this? It is a book correcting carnal believers and showing them what love and holiness actually require.

Truthfulness Is One of the Hardest Purges

Bring this down into our own lives. I want the salt purged out of mine.

One of the hardest things I entered into was putting away lying and speaking truth with my neighbor. Ephesians says the first piece of armor is:

Loins girt about with truth.

Like Abraham, from whose loins came seed that continued after him, a lie has its own life. Long after you stop lying, the lie can keep destroying people.

In this world system, even in ministry circles, I have never swum upstream so hard as when God began purging me to speak truth. When you start walking in truth, you become obvious. You flow against the current and stand out.

A sweet water well is the same toward the person he can gain nothing from as toward the person who can benefit him. The more godly you become in Christ Jesus, the more upstream you swim, and the more you become a testimony.

Character Costs More Than Convenience

When you begin paying the price to walk in truth, you may refuse to change even one dollar on your tax form, even if hiding that dollar would save five thousand dollars. The accountant may say he can cover it up, but you know. That is character.

If someone asks you to lie so he can keep his job, you may want to help him, but you cannot lie for him. That kind of refusal may cost you in the moment, but it reveals what makes your God God and what makes you a Christian.

When you pay that kind of price, you do not dishonor truth easily.

I want to be the same to someone I can get nothing from as I am to someone who can benefit me. Many times people mold their character to serve someone because they think that person may benefit them later. But sweet water does not change depending on what it can gain.

Fellowship With God Requires Truth in the Home and Workplace

We love to lift our hands and say, "Oh, how I love Jesus." But if we just told our child to say we were not home, the father of lies has gained ground.

Everyone eventually does what he truly wants. If a person wants to be here, he will end up here. If he wants to work, he will eventually change things so he can work.

When we first preached on lying, the altars filled across the front. I wanted to exhort more people to come but did not know what to say, so I finally blurted out, "Any more liars out there?" A woman came forward but said she could not get through because two preachers were blocking her path.

This touches all of us.

Sweet Water Swims Upstream Before the World

First Corinthians 6 speaks to believers suing one another. As a Christian, quit suing people. You are called to swim upstream.

When I worked in a mill pulling finished boards off a chain, the men mocked me hard. They rolled on the ground, shouted "holy roller," and made fun of me. But when one man's baby died and he needed someone to drive him out of town, none of his drinking buddies would go. He asked me.

I asked why, since he had mocked me the most. He said, "Because I knew you would do it." He was right.

When revival came to town, every man I worked with came to the meeting. They respected the reality of a walk with God. They had tried to break it down because they hoped it was real.

Your first testimony in the workplace is to outwork them, produce more, and be an example. When you have opportunity, witness. What you are is louder than what you say for a long time.

The Bigger the Platform, the Bigger the Guns

When I began preaching camp meetings, the attacks became larger. After my first long fast, much salt was purged out of me, and I wanted sweet water to flow at any personal cost.

At one gathering of ministers, God had told me to speak to a well-known man about overcoming the flesh. When an opportunity opened, I told him God had given me a message for him. He recoiled as if branded and said nothing was wrong. Later he told other ministers I operated in witchcraft.

Years later it came out that he had been in sin at the time. But for several years many preachers would not touch me because of what he said.

The higher you go, the bigger the guns. That is why you must understand that how people react to agape love is irrelevant. What people do to you is irrelevant. Fall in love with Jesus independent of people and circumstances, and He will line up your circumstances.

When sweet water flows, I can worship God and call good things down on those who hurt me. My testimony is not for sale. Holding up the character of Jesus is the highest calling.

Sweet Water Flows Best Toward the Ones Who Cannot Benefit You

A sweet water well flows toward the smallest, most insignificant believer the same way it flows toward someone important. It is honest and gracious to the person who can do nothing for it.

Salt water wells are at their best in the presence of someone who can exalt them. When they are finished using you, they discard you.

The more you pray in the Holy Ghost, the harder it becomes for a salt water well to operate around you. More and more, the only people who do me in are the ones I allow.

Paul Says the Least Esteemed Can Judge Matters More Purely

First Corinthians 6 says:

Dare any of you, having a matter against another, go to law before the unjust, and not before the saints?

Do ye not know that the saints shall judge the world?

Know ye not that we shall judge angels?

Paul is speaking of the world to come, when the last Adam has all things under His feet, death is defeated, and we share His inheritance in a new heaven and new earth.

Then Paul says:

If then ye have judgments of things pertaining to this life, set them to judge who are least esteemed in the church.

That is incredible. Why choose the least esteemed? Because the one who stands to gain nothing from the situation may judge more accurately. He is not being courted, flattered, or manipulated. He is just a believer who comes, eats his own bread, prays, and has nothing to gain from either side.

A sweet water well will flow to that person as freely as to the mighty.

Becoming Sweet Water Means Letting Prayer Anchor the Character

If we want to become sweet water wells, we must let the Holy Spirit deal with the reservoir. The tongue will eventually report what is inside.

Praying in the Holy Ghost, meditating the Word, and walking in truth begin changing the reservoir. The more God purges, the less deception can dress itself as spirituality. The sweet water begins to flow more consistently.

I do not want to be sweet only in public or in the presence of those who can help me. I want to be sweet before the least esteemed, before family, before those who cannot advance me, and before God.

That is how the salt comes out.